

ANTONIO RUIZ

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Professional Summary

Bilingual IT and Compliance Professional with extensive training in Governance, Risk, and Compliance frameworks and hands-on experience conducting NIST-based control audits, semi-quantitative risk assessments, threat modeling, and automated cloud policy enforcement. Expert at translating complex operational data and framework mandates across diverse teams to eliminate organizational compliance gaps. Seeking to leverage strong analytical, technical auditing, and governance expertise to support eDiscovery lifecycle management, audit readiness initiatives, and enterprise risk reduction.

Core Skills

- **GRC & Frameworks:** NIST SP 800-53, NIST SP 800-30, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO/IEC 27001, COBIT, GRC Fundamentals, SAP GRC Essentials
- **Audit & Risk Analysis:** Policy Development & Governance, Semi-Quantitative Risk Assessment, Threat Modeling, Control Testing, Operational Alignment, Vendor Risk Management (SOC 2 Evaluation)
- **Technical Environments:** Linux (Advanced System Optimization, Terminal Configuration, User Management via 'usermod'), Open-Source Infrastructures, Open Policy Agent (OPA), Rego, JSON, AWS IAM, CI/CD Pipelines
- **Programming & Web:** Object-Oriented Programming Logic, Systems Analysis, Automated Web Systems (Wix Architecture)
- **Languages:** Fluent Bilingual (English / Spanish) – Facilitating cross-border audit documentation, personnel interviews, and evidence translation

Professional Experience

GRC Analyst & Policy-as-Code Practicum | *Independent Focus / Sandbox Environments*

2026 – Present | *Remote / Independent*

- **Cloud Policy-as-Code Automation:** Designed and implemented automated, context-aware policy gates to enforce continuous compliance and preventative security controls within a cloud deployment pipeline.
- **Rego & JSON Control Evaluation:** Developed declarative **Rego** policy rules to programmatically audit incoming **AWS JSON** configuration payloads against organizational security baselines, ensuring infrastructure integrity.

- **Continuous Compliance Enforcement:** Engineered "hard gate" pipeline enforcement mechanisms that automatically intercept and terminate deployment workflows if critical data protection rules are violated (e.g., public production storage buckets).
- **Context-Aware Guardrails:** Implemented logical exceptions to separate development sandboxes from strict production compliance criteria, successfully balancing engineering flexibility with rigorous boundary protection (**NIST SP 800-53** alignment).
- **NIST Control Auditing:** Prepared, executed, and reported on comprehensive compliance audits targeting a specialized subset of NIST SP 800-53 cybersecurity controls using structured personnel interviews, technical document reviews, and robust system validation tests.
- **Risk Assessment Modeling:** Semi-quantitatively analyzed systemic cybersecurity risk utilizing the NIST SP 800-30 methodology to identify, catalog, and prioritize highest-risk vulnerabilities and weaknesses, successfully validating targeted remediation strategies.
- **Threat Modeling:** Executed comprehensive threat modeling exercises to determine high-likelihood threat events, successfully translating raw threat intelligence data into actionable corporate cybersecurity risk modeling.
- **Policy Governance & Alignment:** Developed formal Information Security policies and policy management processes establishing authorized access management and authenticator lifecycle management protocols for internal and third-party corporate personnel, ensuring policy statements accommodated real-world business constraints.
- **Framework Implementation & Remediation:** Utilized the Core Functions of the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF)—Identify, Protect, Detect, Respond, and Recover—to construct, facilitate, and audit corporate information security programs, mapping control gaps back to active risk treatment registers.

Independent Technical & Curricula Specialist

2026 | *Puerto Rico*

- **Curriculum Architecture:** Designed, developed, and executed specialized, technical training curricula for diverse demographics, successfully translating highly complex theoretical frameworks and technical skills into structured, actionable, and measurable learning paths.
- **Performance Auditing:** Established formal evaluation metrics and rigorous performance benchmarks to track, audit, and systematically report student and system progress over multi-year operational cycles.
- **Operations & Billing:** Oversaw comprehensive operational administration, encompassing complete client lifecycles, precise financial billing architecture, and robust data tracking infrastructure optimized for long-term customer retention.

Education

- **Simply Cyber Academy (2026)** – Simply Cyber GRC Analyst Masterclass
- **Alison Professional Platform (2026)** – Diploma, Governance, Risk, and Compliance (GRC) Fundamentals & Essentials of SAP GRC (*Awarded 7 CPE Credits*)

- **IBC (Caguas, PR)** – Associate Degree, Computer Programming
- **Inter American University of Puerto Rico (Cupey, PR)** – Associate Degree, Music Education

Certifications/Courses

- **Simply Cyber GRC Analyst Masterclass** – Simply Cyber Academy (2026)
- **Fundamentals of Governance, Risk, and Compliance (GRC) & Essentials of SAP GRC** – Alison (2026) | *Credential earned: Diploma in GRC Fundamentals & Essentials of SAP GRC (7 CPE credits)*